

CULTURE

Uniting for a Sustainable Fashion Future: The Power of Collective Action

On the urgent need for collective action over individual guilt in the fight against fast fashion — the industry's exploitation of labour, child workers, and the environment demands systemic reform, not just personal choices about what you wear.

BY DHAIRYA MISHRA



Photo: Dhairya Mishra

The ugly truth of fast fashion hides behind the glitter and glamour of the social media posts of a generation that does not wish to repeat an outfit. The OOTD (Outfit of the Day) is turning into DOTD (Disaster of the Decade) (I think I'm funny).

Imagine a little child toiling away in a factory for long hours under OSHA-certified 'hazardous' conditions, in order to satisfy your need for quick & cheap clothes. Consider the degree of damage caused when plastic waste from polyester factories enters the stomachs of threatened sea turtles. The impact that our choices in clothing have on the world around us is heartbreaking.

But they are choices , after all. We can always make different ones.

First: Scrap the Guilt

Our sociological collective has a problem with denialism, of shifting blame from all the places it need to be back to the unitary, powerless individual that doesn't even have the authority to refuse it. And I do wish it goes to therapy sometime soon, for its sake if not mine, but it doesn't change the fact that something is better than nothing, & for the while that Gates & Bezos refuse to do their parts, I would like to do something other than crying with my thumb up my ass.

So there's the (multi)billion-dollar question: if it comes down to it, is there a way for us puny, insignificant, middle-class individuals to undo, even in fraction, some of the damage that's being done to the bigger picture? You're one microscopic cog in his catastrophic plan, designed & directed by his red right hand, yada yada, understood. Is there a way, at least, for us to wash our hands clean?

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2 →

FEATURES

Understanding H3N2: Symptoms, Transmission, and Prevention

An explainer on the H3N2 influenza virus — its origins in the 1968 Hong Kong pandemic, how it spreads, what symptoms to watch for, and what protection is available as the strain continues to concern health professionals worldwide.

BY MOULI SHARMA



Photo: Mouli Sharma

Have you ever considered how much of an impact your health can have on your life? Your physical health has a significant impact on your overall quality of life, affecting everything from your mood to your level of energy. Tragically, numerous dangers to our well-being can crash our arrangements and leave us feeling powerless. The H3N2 influenza virus, which has been causing health professionals concern in recent years, is one such threat.

What is H3N2 influenza?

In 1968, the H3N2 influenza strain was first observed in Hong Kong. It quickly spread to other nations, including the United States, from there. In September 1968, the first H3N2 influenza outbreak occurred in the United States. It quickly spread across the country, triggering a pandemic that lasted until 1970. Since then, H3N2 has evolved into a seasonal flu virus with global distribution and annual outbreaks. The annual flu vaccine contains the virus, which is still present worldwide.

How did it emerge?

It is believed that genetic reassortment led to the emergence of H3N2 influenza. This happens when two unique seasonal viruses (human flu virus and an avian flu virus for this situation) taint a similar host cell and trade hereditary material, bringing about another virus with an alternate mix of qualities from the original viruses.

How did it spread?

H3N2 influenza spreads worldwide through human-to-human transmission and international travel. India may have been infected with H3N2 influenza due to international travel or an infected person entering the country. The virus can quickly spread from person to person once it is introduced to a population, especially in crowded places like schools, offices, and public transportation. In previous flu seasons, H3N2 influenza was reported in India. It will likely continue to be a seasonal flu virus here.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2 →

Uniting for a Sustainable Fashion Future: The Power of - CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

Rich Dad Poor Dad

Of course, one of the larger ways in which a consumer can exercise supposed 'agency' in the market, is his investment choices; & the implication here should be clear enough: if you don't have capital to invest, you don't have capital to make ethical decisions. Beggars, choosers, & all that jazz. So another requisite to understand here, as will be discussed below, is privilege. The obligation to make good choices as a consumer comes with what is first, the privilege to make choices at all. So it should be understood hereon that advice on where within the fashion sector you should invest & on what is less Rich Dad Poor Dad finance guru talk & more The Good Place perspectives on ethical consumption.

Bad Advice Can Be Good Advice

Start by deciding on eco-friendly and sustainable materials that are less or just not harmful to the environment, such as organics like cotton, hemp, or recycled textiles. It may sound elementary, but sticking it out with the good old organics can be a deceptively effective way to decrease one's reliance on quick fashion. Think about how many t-shirts you've gone through in the last 5 years versus how many your parents did when you were growing up. How many did your grandparents? A good organic polyblend will last longer ; the point of buying a 1000-dollar jacket may not be a wise expenditure in any economic pool of thought outside of Shark Tank, but it can be to minimize the resources exhausted in the making of the alternative five.

Think about it - fast fashion is like fast food. It might be cheaper at a time, but absurdly more expensive & wasteful put together as long-term expenditures, thereby trapping lower income groups in a vicious cycle that coerces them to take part in the very consumption patterns that drain them, both ethically & financially.

If you've got the money, eat a salad, & wear cotton, not only because you can, but because doing so is the only way to ensure you won't need to down the line, either. There's many a survivor of unHappy meals who will resent you a little less for using your privilege right.

Think about it, fast fashion is like fast food. It might be cheaper at a time, but absurdly more expensive & wasteful put together during long-term expenditures, thereby trapping lower income groups in a vicious cycle that coerces them to take part in the very consumption patterns that drain them, both ethically & financially.
Dhairya Mishra, Uniting for a Sustainable Fashion Future: The Power of Collective Action

- DHAIRYA MISHRA, UNITING FOR A SUSTAINABLE FASHION FUTURE: THE POWER OF COLLECTIVE ACTION

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3 →

Understanding H3N2: Symptoms, Transmission, and Preven - CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

WHO and The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare in India on H3N2 flu

The World Health Organization (WHO) reported that H3N2 and influenza B viruses were among the most prevalent flu viruses worldwide during the 2019–2020 flu season. The World Health Organization (WHO) and The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare in India intently screen the worldwide flow of flu infections, including H3N2, and give direction and suggestions to nations on influenza counteraction and control techniques.

WHO believes H3N2 flu to be one of the most disturbing influenza subtypes because of its capacity to change quickly and cause extreme sickness, especially in more established grown-ups and small kids. WHO says that everyone should get vaccinated against seasonal flu, including H3N2, every year to avoid getting sick and spreading the virus to other people. In addition to vaccinating people, the WHO encourages people to cover coughs and sneezes, wash their hands frequently, and stay inside when they are ill. WHO also recommends taking antiviral medications to treat severe cases of the flu, including H3N2 influenza.

It is the responsibility of the Indian government to monitor influenza-like illness (ILI) and severe acute respiratory illness (SARI) and to issue periodic reports on the country's flu virus epidemic. When traveling to areas where flu virus outbreaks are known to have occurred, the health ministry advises travelers to take precautions.

What are the symptoms of H3N2 influenza?

H3N2 influenza, also known as the H3N2 flu can cause respiratory disease in people. The symptoms of H3N2 influenza are similar to those of other types of influenza and may include fever, cough, sore throat, runny or stuffy nose, muscle or body aches, headaches, fatigue, vomiting, and diarrhea (more common in children). These symptoms typically begin to manifest one to three days after exposure to the virus and can persist for up to a week or more. H3N2 influenza can sometimes result in more serious complications like pneumonia, especially in young children, the elderly, and people with weak immune systems. It is essential to seek medical attention as soon as you suspect you or a loved one has the flu to receive the necessary treatment and avoid complications.

H3N2 influenza can cause death, especially in people who are more likely to get complications. These incorporate small kids, old people, pregnant ladies, and individuals with fundamental ailments like asthma, diabetes, or coronary illness. H3N2 influenza can result in complications like pneumonia, respiratory failure, and even death in severe cases.

How to prevent H3N2 influenza?

Getting vaccinated, washing your hands frequently, avoiding close contact with sick people, covering your mouth and nose, cleaning and disinfecting surfaces, and taking care of your health are all ways to lower your risk of contracting H3N2 influenza. You can help protect yourself and those around you and lower your risk of contracting H3N2 influenza and other illnesses by following these steps.

Conclusion

CULTURE

बोया पेड़ बबूल का

नितिन नीरा चंद्रा और दिनेश मिश्रा की डॉक्यूमेंट्री 'बोया पेड़ बबूल का' की समीक्षा – जो बाढ़ की त्रासदी और इंसानी लालच के बीच की कड़वी सच्चाई को सामने रखती है। 2008 के कुशाहा तटबंध टूटने की याद और आज भी जारी पीड़ा की पृष्ठभूमि में एक ज़रूरी फिल्म।

BY MOULI SHARMA



Photo: Mouli Sharma

"रेत पर चलता हूं मैं, पेट भरने के लिए रेत तो नहीं खा सकता हूं? मैं तो जानवर हो गया हूं: ऊंट" - बाढ़ पीड़ित

- बाढ़ पीड़ित



Photo: Mouli Sharma

ईमेज	क्रेडिट	:-	डायरेक्टर - नितिन नीरा चंद्रा, दिनेश मिश्रा	प्रोड्यूसर -
https://youtu.be/QsLGBm5kdtU				

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3 →

Uniting for a Sustainable Fashion Future: The Power of - CONTINUED FROM PAGE 2

Checking Your Investments: 5 Minute Crafts

Thirty different audiences & thirty different looks for them to look at. And if all that sounds like a bit much, throw it back in the bin.

If you get bored even thinking about it thirty times, you have no business taking it home.

Werk, bitch.

Not only should we choose our clothing carefully, but we need to style it well. Yes, you heard that right, all those pinterest style videos pinned up on your autumn aesthetics board & instagram style reels clogging up your saves are weapons in your climate fashion war & a soft cottage core girl will inherit the earth. Keep up.

Jokes aside, it's important to remember that the villain is not fashion here. The villain is industry. The villain is mass production without regulation, & mass consumption without thought. When the title says sustainable fashion, it does still mean fashion. Reread the first section again if you must, but don't forget, you are not where the blame lies. If the world goes down in flames 5 decades from now it will not be because a young girl with seemingly vain tastes wanted to dress up cute.

Your joys are not killing the world. You can want to look good, & you can want to spend time & resources on doing so. But being thoughtful about techniques can help minimise the amount of resources that go to waste, & the argument becomes simple: if your looks are entirely dependent on the money you spend on them, you're not fashionable, you're just rich.

A single article of clothing can be dressed in a variety of ways to produce various looks, which can help the garment last longer and decrease waste. The point is, you don't have to look up a list of sustainable fashion influencers to be sustainable, even just putting a bit more effort into doing fashion right can be sustainable.

Tokyo Thrift: Macklemore Them Tags

Swades

Conclusion

Congratulations, you made it. So, to conclude, depending on where in the world it is that you're shopping, it can be more or less sustainable to buy expensive or cheap. (Fascinating how that can happen. It's almost as if one needs to look at who one is paying & what for, along with how much.)

It's important to understand that the key takeaway here is not to consume in a way that is completely ethical (if you've either seen The Good Place or studied higher economics, (two equivalent philosophical qualifications) you might be familiar with the fact that that isn't quite possible) but simply more ethical than all viable alternatives.

"We do not need a handful of people doing zero waste perfectly. We need millions of people doing it imperfectly." Anne Marie Bonneau, Zero Waste Chef

— ANNE MARIE BONNEAU, ZERO WASTE CHEF

बोया पेड़ बबूल का - CONTINUED FROM PAGE 2



Photo: Mouli Sharma

"बोया पेड़ बबूल का" यहीं शीर्षक है इस डॉक्यूमेंट्री फिल्म का। मैंने बहुत सोचा की क्या ये फिल्म इस बार के विषय के अनुरूप है, अंततः मेरे नज़रों में कृषि के होते उपज को लेकर त्योहार और खुशियां मनाई जाती हैं तो कृषि को हुए नुकसान और इसके प्रभावों को भी दिखाना अथवा बताना आवश्यक हो जाता है।

जब मैंने डॉक्यूमेंट्री फिल्म "बोया पेड़ बबूल का" देखा ... अनुभव और किस्से जहन में उभर आए।

साल 2017 में पहली बार बाढ़ को अपने आँखों से देखा। साल 2020 .. जब पूरी दुनिया कोरोना महामारी से जूझ रही थी..तब दूसरी बार मैंने हमारे इलाके को जुलाई अगस्त में बाढ़ से ग्रथित देखा। सन् 1912 या 2002 के समय आई त्रासदी के बारे में दादी से सुना था।

नदी किसी के पास आकार नहीं कहती की मेरे किनारे को तुम बांध दो, नदी स्वतंत्र है। जब नदी के स्वतंत्रता से आधुनिक छद्म विकाश, लालच भरी निगाहों से खिलवाड़ करता है तो इसका नुकसान सिर्फ ईसानों को ही नहीं होता अपितु इसके जद में सब होते हैं।

साल 2008 में कुशाहा तटबंध के टूटने पर जो मानव निर्मित बाढ़ आई थी, उसका प्रकोप आज भी एक बड़े हिस्से के ऊपर देखने को मिलता है। विस्थापन, पलायन, बेरोजगारी, भुखमरी ये सब एक आम समस्या बनकर रह गया है, जिसके ऊपर न राज्य सरकार ही ध्यान दे रहीं हैं न केंद्र सरकार। हर साल मॉनसून के साथ ही इस समस्या के ऊपर राजनीति गरमा जाता है। विधानसभा, लोकसभा चुनावों में बाढ़ के निदान को लेकर लोक-लुभावन वादें हर जगह सुनाई देते हैं। पर इतने सालों के स्वतंत्रता के बाद भी बाढ़ के समस्या का निदान बिहार को नहीं मिल पाया है। राहत-सामग्री और राहत-शिविरों से स्थाई समाधान कभी नहीं मिल सकता है।

इस डॉक्यूमेंट्री फिल्म को निश्चित ही देखना चाहिए ताकि ये समझा जा सके की जिसे हम कोसी की त्रासदी मान रहे हैं वो दरअसल मानव निर्मित बाढ़ है।खैर त्योहार तो हर जगह हर मौसम में मनाया ही जाता है। जो किसान पलायन करके दूसरे शहरों में गया, त्योहारों के वक्त भी अपने घर लौट नहीं पाया, जो खेती के लिए उपजाऊ जमीन थी, अब वो भी मरू भूमि बन चुकी है। वहां के बच्चों को न शिक्षा का साधन है न ही पेट भरने और शरीर ढकने के लिए संसाधन। ऐसे में त्योहारों और फसलों के बारे में जिक्र से ज्यादा जरूरी इस समस्या के ऊपर जागरूकता और समाधान को ढूढना हो जाता है।

अंत में मुझे याद आता है फणीश्वरनाथ रेणु की लिखी कहानी "इस जल प्रलय में"। कहानी डॉक्यूमेंट्री फिल्म से अलग नहीं है पर इसके जैसे भी नहीं है।फिल्म जरूर देखे .. वक्त मिले तो कहानी भी अवश्य पढ़ें।

शिल्पी कुमारी



READ APRIL 2023 ONLINE

The Voice Express · April 2023